

SCALE

0 200 miles
0 200 kilometers

Power struggles

The countries of medieval Europe fought over land but shared a strong belief in the Christian religion.



Peasants farming, late 15th century

Peasants in the Middle Ages

Most people lived as poor peasants, farming the land for the rich. Many were serfs, who were not free. They worked for a lord in exchange for land to grow their own food on.

KEY (c.1400)

VENICE City-states
Some powerful cities became tiny countries in their own right.

Borders
These lines show the borders between countries.

Cogs
Merchant ships called cogs carried the Black Death to Europe's ports

Black Death
The plague spread in these regions, carried by rat fleas.



Black Death burial scene, 1349

Black Death

In the 1340s, the Black Death, a deadly disease carried by rat fleas, arrived in Europe. It spread quickly across the whole continent and killed between a third and two-thirds of Europe's population.

